

Dedi: Server Management Guide

Daily Operations and Administration

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Server Control Operations

Starting and Stopping Your Server

Starting the Server

1. **Launch Dedi** and go to the **Server** tab
2. **Verify Prerequisites:** Ensure all checklist items are green 
3. **Click Start:** The button will show "Start" when server is stopped
4. **Monitor Startup:** Watch status indicators change in sequence:
 - Server connecting to Steam
 - Chat connection established
 - World activation

Startup Time: Normal startup takes 30-60 seconds depending on world size.

Stopping the Server

1. **Click Stop:** Button shows "Stop" when server is running
2. **Wait for Shutdown:** Allow 10-15 seconds for graceful shutdown
3. **Verify Closure:** All status indicators should turn red 

 **Important:** Always use Dedi's Stop button rather than closing Dedi entirely. This ensures proper server shutdown.

Emergency Restart

If server becomes unresponsive:

1. Close Dedi completely
 2. Wait 30 seconds
 3. Relaunch Dedi
 4. Start server normally
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Monitoring Your Server

Understanding Status Indicators

Connection Status

-  **Steam installed:** Steam client found on system
-  **SteamCmd installed:** Server download tools ready
-  **SteamCmd updated:** Latest server files available
-  **Steam Authentication Token:** Valid server authentication
-  **Aska Dedicated Server installed:** Server files present
-  **Aska Server Properties file installed:** Configuration file ready
-  **Aska Server connected to Steam:** Live Steam connection
-  **Aska Server connected to Chat:** Chat services active
-  **Aska World active:** Game world loaded and running

Server Statistics

- **Up Time:** Total time server has been running (format: 000h 00m 00s)
- **Active Time:** Time world has been loaded (resets when world closes)
- **Crash Restarts:** Number of automatic restarts due to crashes

Status Panel Messages

The Status Panel shows real-time server activity:

Normal Operation Messages

- Starting the Server - Server startup initiated
- Player: [Name] : connected - Player joined
- Player: [Name] : disconnected - Player left
- World saved successfully! - Autosave completed

- `Backed up Save from [source] to [destination]` - Backup created

Warning Messages

- `Server crashed, restarting server` - Automatic recovery
- `Couldn't find World Generation file` - Missing save data
- `Authentication token errors` - Steam authentication issues

Error Messages

- `Failed to start server` - Startup failure
- `Steam connection lost` - Network issues
- `Invalid configuration` - Settings problems

Reading the Player List

The **Player List** panel shows:

- **Real-time connected players**
 - **Maximum 4 players displayed** (scrollable if more)
 - **Updates every few seconds**
 - **Names as they appear in-game**
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Player Management

Player Connection Monitoring

When Players Join

1. **Automatic Backup:** Save file backed up to `saves/user/[playername]/`
2. **Status Message:** Connection logged in Status Panel
3. **Player List Update:** Name appears in Player List
4. **World Activation:** If first player, world becomes active

When Players Leave

1. **Status Message:** Disconnection logged
2. **Player List Update:** Name removed from list
3. **World Shutdown:** If last player and "World Alive" is false

Backup Management per Player

- **Automatic:** Backup created every time player joins

- **Maximum Saves:** Configurable (default: 10 per player)
- **Cleanup:** Oldest saves automatically deleted when limit exceeded
- **Location:** `[Dedi folder]/saves/user/[Saveld]_[DateTime]/`

Managing Problem Players

Emergency Player Removal

If you need to remove a problematic player:

1. **Restart Server:** Stop and start the server
2. **All players disconnected:** Everyone must rejoin
3. **Password Protection:** Add password in Config → Server → Password
4. **Regenerate Properties:** Click Generate button
5. **Restart Server:** Apply new password

Rollback to Previous Save

If players cause world corruption:

1. **Stop Server**
 2. **Navigate to:** `saves/user/` or `saves/server/`
 3. **Find Recent Backup:** Look for backups before the problem
 4. **Manual Restore:** Copy backup files to your Aska save location
 5. **Restart Server**
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Backup Management

Understanding Backup Types

Server Backups

- **When Created:** Every world save (based on Autosave Style)
- **Location:** `saves/server/[Saveld]_[DateTime]/`
- **Maximum Count:** Configurable (default: 5)
- **Contains:** Complete world state at save time

User Backups

- **When Created:** Every time a player connects
- **Location:** `saves/user/[Saveld]_[DateTime]/`
- **Maximum Count:** Configurable (default: 10)

- **Contains:** World state when player joined

Backup Settings Configuration

Adjusting Backup Limits

1. **Go to Config Tab**
2. **Dedi Section:**
 - **Server Saves:** 1-20 (recommend 5-10)
 - **User Saves:** 1-50 (recommend 10-20)
3. **Save Configuration**

Autosave Frequency

1. **Config Tab → Server Section**
2. **Autosave Style** options:
 - - Once per in-game day (recommended)
 - - No automatic saves (not recommended)
 - - Very frequent (high disk usage)
 - - Frequent
 - - Moderate
 - - Conservative

Manual Backup Operations

Create Manual Backup

1. **Wait for World Save:** Look for "World saved successfully!" message
2. **Check Backup Creation:** Status will show backup confirmation
3. **Verify Files:** Check appropriate saves folder

Restore from Backup

1. **Stop Server**
2. **Locate Backup:** Navigate to saves folder
3. **Identify Target:** Find backup by timestamp
4. **Manual Copy:** Copy backup files to Aska save directory
5. **Restart Server**

Save Location:

Server Maintenance

Regular Maintenance Tasks

Daily Tasks

- **Check Server Status:** Verify all indicators are green
- **Monitor Crash Restarts:** Should remain at 0
- **Review Player Activity:** Check connection/disconnection patterns
- **Backup Verification:** Ensure recent backups exist

Weekly Tasks

- **Cleanup Old Backups:** Manually remove very old backup folders if needed
- **Review Disk Space:** Ensure adequate free space (backups can grow large)
- **Check for Updates:** Visit Dedi GitHub for new releases
- **Configuration Backup:** Save your Config.ini and Options.ini files

Monthly Tasks

- **Full Server Restart:** Stop and start server to clear memory
- **Update Aska Server:** Use Install button to update to latest version
- **Archive Old Saves:** Move old backup folders to long-term storage

Configuration Maintenance

Backing Up Configuration

1. **Config Tab → Save Button**
2. **Choose Location:** Save to desktop or cloud storage
3. **Name File:** Use descriptive name like `MyServer_Config_2024-01-15.ini`

Loading Configuration

1. **Config Tab → Load Button**
2. **Select File:** Choose your saved configuration
3. **Verify Settings:** Check all sections loaded correctly
4. **Generate Properties:** Click Generate to apply changes

Troubleshooting Common Issues

Server Won't Start

Symptoms

- Start button doesn't work
- Status indicators remain red
- Error messages in Status Panel

Solutions

1. **Check Prerequisites:** Ensure all checklist items are green
2. **Regenerate Properties:** Config tab → Generate button
3. **Verify Authentication:** Check Steam token is correct
4. **Restart Dedi:** Close and reopen application
5. **Check Disk Space:** Ensure adequate free space

Frequent Server Crashes

Symptoms

- High "Crash Restarts" count
- Players frequently disconnected
- "Server crashed, restarting" messages

Solutions

1. **Check Save ID:** Ensure correct save ID in configuration
2. **Verify World Files:** Check Aska save folder for corruption
3. **Update Server:** Use Install button to get latest files
4. **Reduce Autosave Frequency:** Change to "every morning"
5. **Check System Resources:** Ensure adequate RAM and CPU

Authentication Issues

Symptoms

- "Authentication token errors" in status
- Server starts but players can't connect
- Steam connection fails

Solutions

1. **Regenerate Token:** Get new token from Steam website
2. **Copy Carefully:** Ensure no extra spaces or characters

3. **Check App ID:** Verify using correct Aska App ID (1898300)
4. **Regenerate Properties:** Apply new token with Generate button

Player Connection Problems

Symptoms

- Players can't see server in list
- Server visible but connection fails
- Intermittent connection issues

Solutions

1. **Check Region Setting:** Verify region matches player locations
 2. **Port Conflicts:** Try different Steam Game/Query ports
 3. **Firewall Issues:** Ensure Windows Firewall allows Dedi and AskaServer
 4. **Network Settings:** Check router port forwarding if needed
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Performance Optimization

Server Performance Settings

Optimal Autosave Settings

- **High Performance:** (minimal server load)
- **High Safety:** (frequent backups, higher load)
- **Balanced:** with manual saves during events

Backup Optimization

- **Server Saves:** 3-5 for storage efficiency
- **User Saves:** 5-10 depending on player activity
- **Regular Cleanup:** Archive old backups monthly

System Resource Management

- **Close Unnecessary Programs:** Free up RAM and CPU
- **Adequate Storage:** Maintain 20%+ free disk space
- **Background Tasks:** Minimize Windows updates during peak hours

Network Optimization

Port Configuration

- **Default Ports:** 27015/27016 work for most setups
- **Port Conflicts:** Change if running multiple servers
- **Firewall Rules:** Ensure both TCP and UDP are allowed

Region Selection

- **Match Player Base:** Choose region where most players are located
 - **Network Latency:** Closer regions provide better performance
 - **Load Distribution:** Popular regions may have higher latency
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Advanced Operations

Multiple Server Profiles

Creating Additional Profiles

1. **Save Current Config:** Config tab → Save button
2. **Modify Settings:** Change Profile Name, Server Name, Save ID
3. **Save New Config:** Use different filename
4. **Switch Profiles:** Load different config files as needed

Profile Management

- **Naming Convention:** Use descriptive names (PvP_Server, Creative_Mode)
- **Separate Folders:** Consider separate Dedi installations for complex setups
- **Backup Configs:** Keep copies of all profile configurations

Custom Game Mode Setup

World Generation Customization

1. **Enable in Options:** Options tab → Enable Worldgen
2. **Load World Properties:** World tab → Load button
3. **Modify Settings:** Adjust terrain, difficulty, populations
4. **Save Changes:** World tab → Save button
5. **Set Server Mode:** Config tab → Mode → custom

Advanced World Settings

- **Terrain Aspect:** smooth/normal/rocky
- **Terrain Height:** flat/normal/varied
- **Starting Season:** spring/summer/autumn/winter

- **Year Length:** minimum/reduced/default/extended/maximum
- **Day Length:** minimum/reduced/default/extended/maximum
- **Weather:** 0 (sunny) to 6 (soggy)
- **Population Levels:** low/medium/high for various creatures
- **Invasion Difficulty:** off/easy/normal/viking

Seed Management

Understanding Seeds

- **World Generation:** Determines terrain layout
- **Automatic Detection:** Dedi reads seed from save files
- **Copy Function:** Ctrl+C in seed field to copy
- **Sharing:** Share seeds with friends for identical worlds

Seed Operations

1. **View Current Seed:** Server tab shows current world seed
 2. **Copy Seed:** Click in seed field, use Ctrl+C
 3. **New World:** Create new save in Aska with desired seed
 4. **Update Save ID:** Configure Dedi to use new save
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Best Practices Summary

Daily Server Management

1. **Monitor Status Indicators:** Quick health check
2. **Review Status Panel:** Look for errors or warnings
3. **Check Player Activity:** Ensure backups are working
4. **Verify Up Time:** Confirm stable operation

Weekly Maintenance

1. **Backup Configuration:** Save your settings
2. **Review Disk Usage:** Clean up old backups if needed
3. **Update Check:** Look for new Dedi releases
4. **Performance Review:** Monitor crash restart count

Emergency Procedures

1. **Server Unresponsive:** Restart Dedi completely

2. **World Corruption:** Restore from recent backup
3. **Authentication Failure:** Regenerate Steam token
4. **Configuration Loss:** Load saved configuration file

Your server is now ready for reliable, long-term operation. Regular monitoring and maintenance will ensure optimal performance and player experience.